

Master's Message

Greetings from the East.



Brethren,

As we open the pages of this month's trestle board, we find ourselves standing at a truly historic threshold. This July marks the 250th anniversary of the signing of the Declaration of Independence—a full quarter-millennium since our nation declared its freedom and set forth the enduring principles of life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness. The Fourth of July, so recently celebrated across the country with fireworks, parades, and gatherings of family and friends, is more than a holiday for us as Freemasons. It is a living reminder of the ideals that many of our early Brethren helped shape. From the lodges of colonial America emerged men who risked everything for the cause of liberty, men who understood that the same light that illuminates the temple also illuminates the path to a free and just society. Let us, therefore, pause in gratitude for their courage and renew our own commitment to those timeless values of brotherly love, relief, and truth that continue to strengthen both our Fraternity and our nation.

Closer to home, our own lodge is privileged this month to play its part in the ongoing work of building better men. We will confer two Entered Apprentice degrees, welcoming a pair of fine young candidates who have knocked at our door seeking light. The officers and many dedicated Brethren have been meeting regularly, rehearsing with care and precision, so that every word of the ritual, every movement of the officers, and every moment of the ceremony will leave a lasting and favorable impression upon these new seekers. We know that a candidate's first experience in the lodge often sets the tone for his entire Masonic journey; therefore we are determined to offer them nothing less than our very best. I invite—and

strongly encourage—each of you to take an active part in this important work. There are many ways to contribute: filling a speaking or non-speaking role in the degree, assisting with the preparation of the lodge room, serving as a mentor or guide for our new candidates after the degree, or simply being present to offer a warm handshake and a genuine fraternal welcome. Your presence and your support will help these men feel that they have truly found a home among us. Let us join together to give them the strong, memorable, and inspiring start that every Entered Apprentice deserves.

In the spirit of this remarkable month—when we celebrate both the birth of our nation and the continuing growth of our beloved Craft—I look forward to seeing a strong turnout in lodge. May the light that guided the founders of our country continue to guide our labors, and may the bonds of brotherhood we share grow ever stronger.



Sincerely and fraternally,

Wor. Robert E. Pollard
Worshipful Master, 2026



July 2026

STATED MEETING

JULY 2, 2026

Refreshment: 6pm

Labor: 7pm

EA DEGREE

JULY 9, 2026

Mr. James Harvey

EA DEGREE

JULY 23, 2026

Mr. Brett Adams

Catechism Practice every Monday 6pm, Ritual Practice every
Thursday 6pm (unless there is a Stated or Called Meeting)

ALL ARE ENCOURAGED TO ATTEND.

Lodge Education

America's

In July 2026, the United States marks a profound milestone: the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence, signed on July 4, 1776. This Semiquincentennial invites reflection not only on the birth of a nation dedicated to life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness, but also on the quiet yet significant role that Freemasonry played in the lives of many who helped bring that vision to life.

Freemasonry arrived in the American colonies in the early 18th century, with the first lodges forming under warrants from the Grand Lodge of England. By the 1730s, lodges existed in Philadelphia, Boston, and other colonial centers. These gatherings offered more than ritual and fellowship. In an era of rigid social hierarchies and religious establishments, Masonic lodges provided a space where men of good character—merchants, artisans, professionals, and gentlemen—could meet “on the level,” regardless of rank or creed. The fraternity’s core tenets of brotherly love, relief, and truth, along with its emphasis on religious tolerance, free inquiry, and moral self-improvement, resonated strongly with the Enlightenment ideals then sweeping the Atlantic world.

Many of the men who shaped the American Revolution were active Freemasons. Among the most prominent were George Washington, initiated in 1752 at Fredericksburg Lodge in Virginia; Benjamin Franklin, a devoted Mason who published Anderson’s Constitutions in America and later introduced Voltaire into a Parisian lodge; John Hancock, Paul Revere, and Dr. Joseph Warren (the patriot leader killed at Bunker Hill). Of the 56 signers of the Declaration of Independence, nine are confirmed to have been Freemasons during their lifetimes: William Ellery, Benjamin Franklin, John Hancock, Joseph Hewes, William Hooper, Robert Treat Paine, Richard Stockton, George Walton, and William Whipple.

Freemasonry as an institution did not orchestrate the Revolution. Historians emphasize that individual Masons acted according to their own convictions, and many key founders—Thomas Jefferson and Alexander Hamilton among them—were never members. Yet the shared values cultivated in the lodge room—equality before the law of morality, freedom of conscience, and the right of free men to govern themselves—aligned closely with the

principles articulated in the Declaration and later embodied in the Constitution. Structural parallels have even been noted between Anderson's Masonic Constitutions of 1723 and early American governing documents such as Franklin's Albany Plan of Union.

The connection continued after independence. On September 18, 1793, President George Washington, wearing full Masonic regalia, laid the cornerstone of the United States Capitol in a formal Masonic ceremony. Accompanied by brethren from Maryland and Virginia lodges, he consecrated the stone with the traditional offerings of corn, wine, and oil—symbols of nourishment, refreshment, and joy—before striking it three times with a gavel according to ancient custom. This public act symbolically linked the new republic's seat of government with the moral architecture of the Craft.

As we celebrate America's 250th anniversary, Freemasons can take quiet pride in this heritage without exaggeration. The Fraternity did not create the United States, but many of its members helped shape the character of those who did. The same light that guides a candidate through the Entered Apprentice degree—teaching equality, integrity, and the pursuit of truth—illuminated the minds of men who dared to found a nation on those very principles.

In 2026, as fireworks light the sky and communities gather to honor two and a half centuries of independence, Masons across the country may pause to remember that the work begun in colonial lodges continues in every modern lodge room: building better men, strengthening the bonds of brotherhood, and upholding the ideals that remain as vital today as they were in 1776.

*If anyone else is interested in submitting
an educational piece, please feel free to do so.
Send it to info@ksl6.org and we will get it
scheduled to appear in an upcoming bulletin!
Seriously we would appreciate the help!*



**James Lampley, PM,
32° K. C. C. H.**



The Tennessee Lodge of Research, F. & A. M., is a subordinate lodge instituted to foster and expand knowledge of the history and philosophy of the craft by encouraging masonic study and research, thereby assisting the Grand Lodge in its diffusion of masonic light and education by publishing masonic information and educational material. It was formed in 1983 and received its charter in 1985.

Meetings are held quarterly on the first Saturday of March and the second Saturday of each June, September, and December at high twelve. Meetings are held in different lodges and different geographical areas of Tennessee each quarter. Typically, the March meeting is held in West Tennessee (west of the Tennessee River), the June meeting in Middle Tennessee, the September meeting in the East Tennessee area, and the December meeting at our "home Lodge," Sparta Lodge No. 99 in Sparta, TN.

Normally, a meal is served prior to each meeting and a talk about a Masonic or Masonically affiliated subject is presented at each meeting. These talks are presented by both members and nonmembers and an attempt is made to keep them non-esoteric in nature so they may be printed in the proceedings and can be attended by non-masons.

Master Masons interested in joining the Tennessee Lodge of Research reach out to the Secretary at: secretary@tnlor.org

From the Secretary

Praying all is well with our brethren across the world that are viewing our website to see the exciting events taking place at King Solomon Lodge #6. We at King Solomon Lodge #6 hope that your lodges are active in your communities and introducing good men to Masonry.

As promised in the last edition, here are some of the actions that took place at Tennessee's Grand Lodge Communication in March 2026.

- Brother Joseph Wesley Edens was elected as Most Worshipful Grand Master for the ensuing year. He has a great vision for Masonry in Tennessee and we are looking forward to working with him and the Grand Family team.

- Total number of brethren that registered at the Grand Lodge for the Annual Communication was 991.

- Total membership of Master Masons in Tennessee as of 12/31/2025 was 24,646. Of this number, 5,137 members have 50 or more years of service. Note that the total membership number of 24,646 represents a decrease of 1,092 members from the previous year.

- Bill Woodward Jr., from our neighboring lodge in Hendersonville(#359), was awarded with the Andrew Jackson Medal for 2026.

I will end with a plea to remember to pay your lodge dues if you have not done so for 2026.



**George Snow, PM
Secretary**

Committees

Conduct Committee

Mike Lenart, Chairman, Brad Beaver, Bob Krauth

Auditing Committee

Jim Jones, Chairman

Inquisitorial Committee

Mike Lenart, Chairman, Cody Woodall, Colton McDonald

Budget Committee

Jim Jones, Chairman, James Lampley, Bob Krauth

Social Media

Robbie Pollard, Chairman, James Lampley, Jeff Fullerton

Visiting Committee

Brad Beaver, Chairman, Bob Krauth, Mike Lenart

Charity Committee

Robbie Pollard, Chairman, Mike Lenart, Alan Woodard

Jurisprudence Committee

James Lampley, Chairman, Adam Issa, Alan Woodard

Education Committee

Alan Woodard Chairman (Catechism),

Ron Brawner (Funeral), Frank Oakes (Lecture)

2025 Lodge Officers

Wor. Robert "Eddie" Pollard.....Worshipful Master
Mobile: 615-332-1721, master@ksl6.org

Bro. Michael Lenart.....Senior Warden

Bro. Robbie PollardJunior Warden

Wor. James Lampley, PM.....Treasurer

Wor. George Snow, PMSecretary
Mobile: 452.654.3578, secretary@ksl6.org

Wor. Alan Woodard, PM..... Chaplin

Bro. Jeffery Fullerton.....Senior Deacon

Bro. Robert "Bob" Krauth.....Junior Warden

Bro. Colton McDonald.....Senior Steward

Bro. Cody Woodall.....Junior Steward

Wor. Brad Beaver, PM.....Tiler

info@ksl6.org

Board of Trustees

Wor. Monte Green, PM.....2026

Wor. James Brawner, PM.....2025

Wor. Alan Woodard, PM.....2024

Wor. James Lampley, PM.....2023

Wor. Darren Rosenberry, PM2022

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Lodge Email- info@ksl6.org

Lodge Webpage- www.ksl6.org

Facebook- King Solomon Lodge #6 F&AM